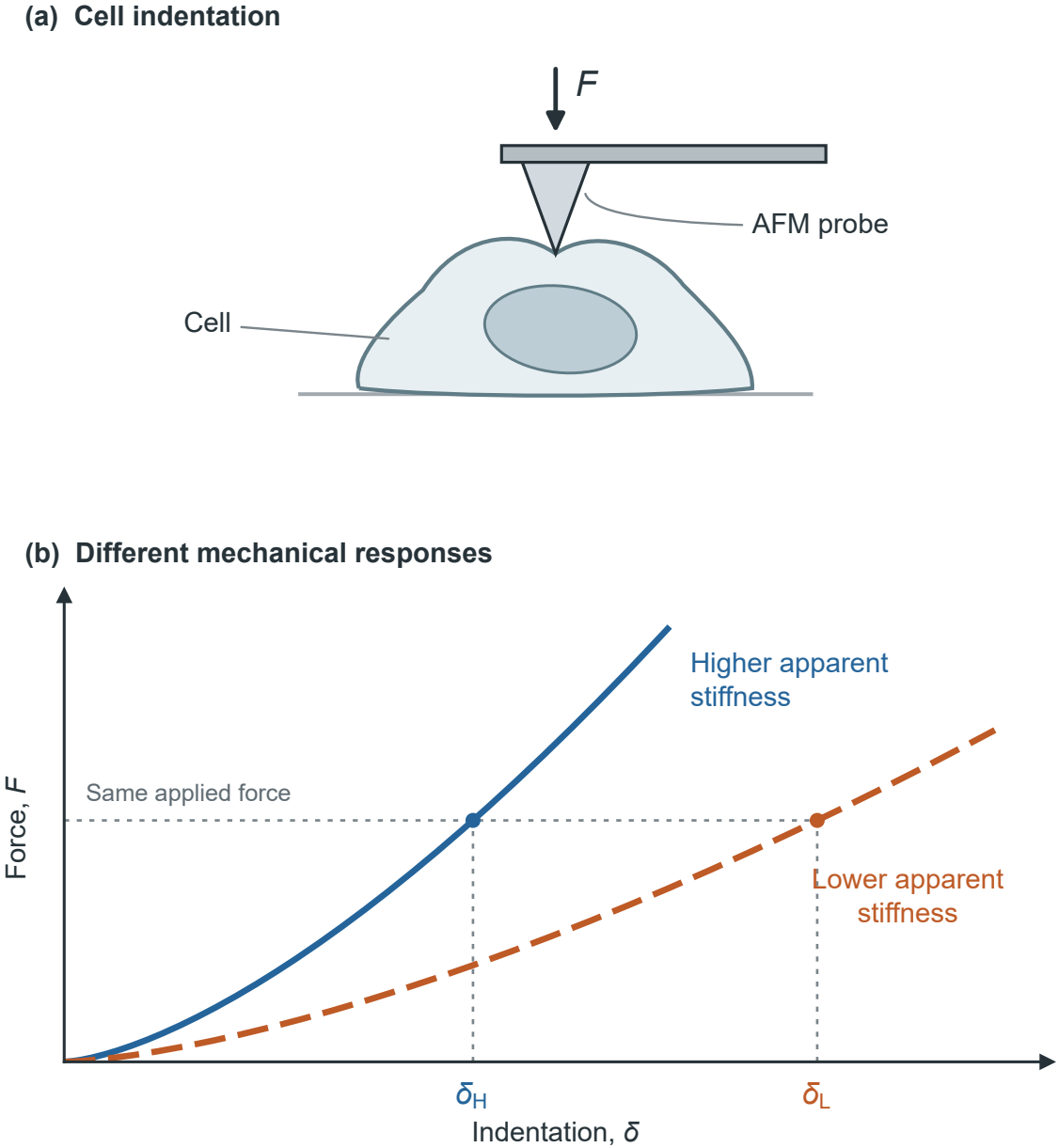
(a) Cell indentation
F
AFM probe
Cell
(b) Different mechanical responses
Higher apparent stiffness
Same applied force
Lower apparent stiffness
Force, F
δH
δL
Indentation, δ